

4. Freeze Breeze

Ever had to deal with sweaty palms after playing for seven hours straight? Worry no more: Logitech has launched the Chillstream Gamepad for the convenience of PS3 folk. This one has air vents towards the bottom on both sides of the controller, which have fans that blow cool air onto your palms, so you are at your agile best when fragging the enemy on a new map.



The "low" setting just blows air onto your palms—what really makes it buzz is the "high" setting, where it starts to get a bit noisy too.

The Good: Keeps palms dry, looks similar to the PS3 SIXAXIS controller

The Not-so-much: Not wireless; can get noisy

Price: \$35 (Rs 1,400)

Available at: <http://tinyurl.com/35ydd9>

2. The Gaming Chair

You'll agree that it a bean bag is the most comfortable way to sit through a game. Now add a 2.1 Dolby setup to that bean bag, and you are in another dimension altogether! The good part for us is that Pyramat has just that (well, almost) with their S2000 range of gaming furniture.

The S2000 boasts of two 3-inch full-range 12-watt speakers located on the shoulders of the chair just behind your ears. It also has one 5.5-inch 20-watt sub-woofer located around the mid area of the back rest. This wizardry doesn't end here—the S2000 has the ability to accept radio-based stereo signals from any audio device with stereo output, wirelessly. It can also broadcast stereo audio via Bluetooth.

The dials and buttons are located on the right of the chair, and can manipulate volume, bass, and input selection. On the right is a headphone jack to which you can connect your MP3 player!

The Good: Good speaker arrangement, Bluetooth functionality, headphone jack **The Not-so-much:** No tweeters **Price:** \$130 (Rs 5,450)

Available at: <http://tinyurl.com/2rqj2x>



3. Strum Your Way Through

The Gibson SG based Guitar Peripheral is one of those console accessories you can spend hours with. You now not only have the option of listening to your favourite songs, you can actually play it too! This comes bundled with Guitar Hero on the Xbox 360 and PS3.

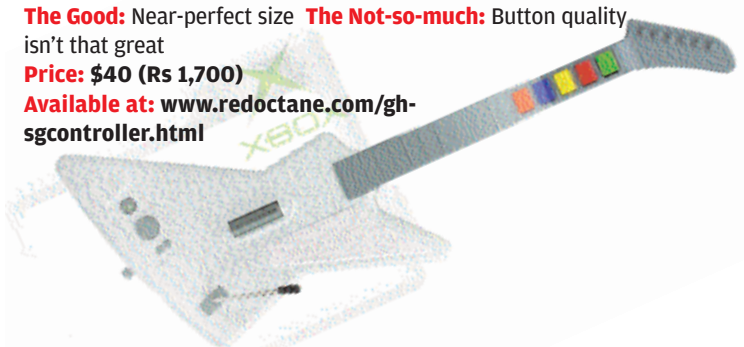
The mini SG comes across as being of the ideal size—not too big and not too ridiculously small either. It has 5 buttons instead of the fret bars, a strummer, and a whammy bar for those moments when you just have to go electric!

Another aspect of the mini SG is the slightly elevated yellow button right in the middle of all the buttons on the neck. This can be a real lifesaver when you get lost between the buttons. A wonderful peripheral to own.

The Good: Near-perfect size **The Not-so-much:** Button quality isn't that great

Price: \$40 (Rs 1,700)

Available at: www.redoctane.com/gh-sgcontroller.html



1. Kung-Fu Fighting

The age of NES controllers was when arcade-style fighting games flourished. It was also a time in which controller and control buttons were simple, and you could just kick or punch your enemy. With the advent of combination moves (combos), controllers got more and more complex with more and more buttons on them. In such a scenario, a gamer with small hands is an outcast, since it is difficult to quickly reach a myriad buttons with small hands. This is where the Fighting Stick 3, manufactured by Hori, comes into the picture. This arcade-style controller will remind you of the NES controller era! Unfortunately for us, it is still sold only in the US and Japan.

The Fighting Stick connects via USB to the console with a cord that is 10 metres long. The designers put some thought into it: this is evident from the rubber grounding used in the legs, and the metallic base which makes sure the stick doesn't move too much while playing. Moreover, the stick has a plastic body with rounded corners which don't come in the way while you're bashing demons. The buttons on the fighting stick are convex for that old-school look. Most of the buttons on the controller are mappable, and are super-sensitive, making for an even better experience.

The joystick moves into four pre-defined corners, unfortunately, and does not have a rounded base, which would have allowed it to move freely.

The Good: Retro, old-school looks

The Not-so-much: Doesn't come in a wireless variation

Price: \$35 (Rs 1,450)

Available at: <http://tinyurl.com/274hom>

